the century, PM Modi converted the crisis and potential into an opportunity. He took bold decisions and took the nation along with him. Health infrastructure was set up and the government worked to enhance the nation's self-confidence and towards *atmanirbharta*. In spite of the supply chain issues because of the Ukraine war and other issues it caused, the Indian economy remained stable—even the IMF has acknowledged that. Now even an agency like Morgan Stanley says that the Indian economy is a bright spot in Asia.

Q. So, what will be the big message that you will go with for 2024, to win a mandate for the third time?

So, now the country feels safe in the hands of Prime Minister Modi. The economy is heading towards the $5 trillion size that we talked about. Now, we are looking at India being a developed country in Amrit Kaal, a Viksit Bharat. The momentum must increase on all fronts, whether in the economy, defence or India's international interests. It is also about the empowerment of the marginal sections of society. Our target is that of a developed India. For that, a mandate is needed, and we believe the people are willing to give us that.

Q. To win the mandate, you seem to be splitting up parties as we have seen in Maharashtra. People thought the BJP was a party with a difference, so why is the party doing this?

There is a difference. In the BJP, right from the Jana Sangh days, our ideology has not been diluted an iota. We talked about nation and nationalism then and we do so now too. The same with Article 370, Ram Janmabhoomi or triple talaq. We stand by our beliefs and we act on them. We are the only party which has been consistent throughout, the only one that has not diluted its ideology. As for the other parties, how did we break them? The late Shiv Sena chief Balasaheb Thackeray had said that he would rather close shop than break bread with the Congress. So, if his son has decided to close the shop, what can I do? We are not diluting our ideology, whoever wants to join us can do so.



"IF THE OPPOSITION THINKS THERE'S ANY WRONGDOING ON THE PART OF THE BJP LEADERS, THEY SHOULD COMPLAIN TO THE ED OR OTHER BODIES"

Q. Even if they are all accused of corruption as in the case of NCP defectors?

The law will take its own course; we don't fiddle with it. But if these people want to join us because of the ideological confusion in their parties, how are we to be blamed? They have come to us, we did not approach them.

Q. You are giving good posts to them. Won't your own loyal party workers feel sidelined?

No one is feeling sidelined. The BJP works in a very scientific way. Those who come from outside adjust to our ways, and those who have always been with us are anyway part of the mainstream. We have the capacity to take everyone with us.

Q. But you seem to have a game plan to decimate the Opposition in all the critical states and prevent them from uniting to take the BJP on.

This talk of Opposition unity is good for photo-ops, but what can these parties give each other? It's all a mirage and we are not afraid of it. I oversaw Uttar Pradesh in the 2019 Lok Sabha polls when the SP and BSP were fighting together. Everyone was saying, it's a lethal combination. But I told them, 'It's not all about mathematics but